

SERVING PLAN 2 SERVING PLAN

Middle Eastern Meatballs

with Cauliflower-Apricot Tabbouleh and Pine Nuts

While we love dried apricots as a snack or sprinkled over our breakfast granola, they also work well in savory dishes. Here, they simmer with bulgur until plump and tender, adding a tart-sweet note to the cauliflower, cucumber, and tomato salad. It's also a nice contrast to the Saudi Arabian spice mix in the meatballs, known as kabsa—a warming blend of ground clove, cardamom, and cumin.

30–40 minutes 800 calories per serving

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MEALS WORTH MAKING

Ingredients

- 6 ounces cauliflower florets
- 2 ounces dried apricots
- 2 cloves garlic
- 1 tablespoon pine nuts
- 1 teaspoon Saudi Arabian spice mix
- 12 ounces ground beef
- ½ cup bulgur wheat
- 1 tomato
- 2 Persian cucumbers
- 1 herb mix
  - ¼ ounce mint
  - ¼ ounce parsley
- 1 lemon
- 2 ounces crumbled feta cheese

You'll need

- olive oil
- 1 egg
- kosher salt
- black pepper
- 8" medium pot with lid
- aluminum foil
- 2 baking sheets
- fine-mesh sieve (optional)

Recipe tips

Be sure to read through the entire recipe before you begin cooking.

Bulgur's tiny grains will slip through most colanders. If you don't have a fine-mesh sieve, remove the bulgur with a slotted spoon and transfer to a large bowl.

Use the remaining lemon to brighten a glass of water or make a simple salad vinaigrette.

USDA recommends cooking ground beef to 160°F.

Questions? Email help@plated.com or call 855-525-2399. Visit plated.me/allergens for more information on dietary restrictions.

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1. Prepare ingredients

Preheat oven to 450°F. Rinse all produce. Bring a medium, covered pot of water to a boil over high heat (to keep water from evaporating before Step 4). Cut **cauliflower** into ¼-inch pieces. Roughly chop **dried apricots**. Mince **garlic**. Place **pine nuts** on a small piece of foil, bring edges together, and seal to form a pouch. Line a baking sheet with foil.



2. Form and bake meatballs

In a large bowl, stir together **Saudi Arabian spice mix**, **garlic**, **1 egg**, **½ teaspoon salt**, and **pepper** as desired. Pat **beef** dry with paper towel and add to bowl. Using your hands, mix well, then form into 10 equal balls, about 1½ inches thick. Arrange **meatballs** on prepared baking sheet, spacing apart as much as possible. Bake until lightly browned and cooked through, about 15 minutes.



3. Roast cauliflower and pine nuts

While meatballs bake, on a separate baking sheet, toss **cauliflower** with **2 teaspoons olive oil**, **¼ teaspoon salt**, and **pepper** as desired. Arrange in a single layer, spacing apart as much as possible. Add **pine nut pouch** to sheet. Roast (with meatballs) until cauliflower is tender and pine nuts are fragrant, 13–15 minutes.



4. Cook bulgur and apricots

While cauliflower and pine nuts roast, season boiling water generously with **salt**. Stir in **bulgur** and **apricots** and cook until tender, about 10 minutes (move on to Step 5, but don't forget to come back). Using a fine-mesh sieve, drain **bulgur and apricots** and return to pot, off heat (see recipe tip). Set aside until Step 6.



5. Prepare remaining ingredients

While bulgur cooks, cut **tomato** and **cucumber** into ¼-inch dice. Roughly chop **mint** and **parsley** leaves, discarding stems. If you have a zester and want to infuse your tabbouleh with even more lemon flavor, zest **up to ½ lemon**, then halve.



6. Finish tabbouleh and plate

To pot with bulgur, still off heat, stir in **feta**, **roasted cauliflower**, **herbs**, **tomato**, **cucumber**, **lemon zest** (if using), **juice of ½ lemon** (see recipe tip), **1 tablespoon olive oil**, **½ teaspoon salt**, and **pepper** as desired to combine. Divide **tabbouleh** between shallow serving bowls and top with **Middle Eastern meatballs**. Garnish with **pine nuts** and enjoy!

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